COMPANION GUIDE

Staying Grounded

Confidence and Resilience Through Challenging Times

Pause and choose

• Notice one observable reaction. Look around or focus on an ordinary object if comfortable. Choose one safe, useful next action. Stop any exercise that does not suit you.

Protect your attention

• Agree when work information needs checking. Mute non-essential commentary. A boundary does not close legitimate complaint, safeguarding or protected-disclosure routes.

Useful words

• To a parent: “I hear your concern. I cannot discuss individual cases here. I can explain the appropriate route.”

• To a friend: “Please don’t forward general commentary to me.”

• To a colleague: “Would listening, practical help or some space be most useful?”

• For a boundary: “I can help with this part; I need support with the rest.”

Know when to escalate

• For a safeguarding concern, listen without investigating, avoid promising secrecy and follow the applicable procedure promptly. Use an alternative or independent route if the usual contact is implicated.

• For abuse or harassment, seek appropriate support and report through the relevant work/platform route. Preserve only safe, permitted evidence securely; do not circulate it. Do not copy or redistribute suspected illegal material or sexual imagery involving children.

• For a direct or immediate safety threat, seek immediate local help.

Your private next-step plan

• One small action within my role: _____

• One boundary: _____

• My verified support route: _____

• One practical change I need: _____

• When I will review: _____

Support and perspective

• Use the support arrangements shared by your school. If the Head or usual contact is involved in the concern, seek the appropriate alternative, independent or external route.

• Persistent, worsening or disruptive distress is a reason to consider qualified support. This guide is educational, not clinical care.

• Education Support resources use UK terminology; their direct services have UK eligibility conditions. Check eligibility and local alternatives.

• Nothing here requires positivity, personal disclosure or public defence of the school. Organisational problems need organisational action.

Sources & further reading

WHO · Doing What Matters in Times of Stress

An illustrated self-help guide with language options and guided audio. Optional further practice, not required course reading.

WHO · Guidelines on mental health at work

Guidelines covering organisational and individual approaches. A reminder that staff wellbeing also depends on working conditions and management.

Education Support · Change and uncertainty in schools

Optional reading about school change and practical support. UK context; verify eligibility for direct support services.

Education Support · Home-School Communication Messaging

A four-page resource for leaders setting communication channels and response expectations. Adapt terminology and procedures locally.

General learning resource. No accreditation or clinical assessment. Use alongside local procedures.